THE KARGIL WAR, 1999

In May 1998, both India and Pakistan declared themselves as nuclear powers, increasing tension in South Asia. In order to reduce the possibility of a nuclear exchange between the two countries, the two prime ministers signed the Lahore Declaration on 21 February 1999. The bonhomie was short-lived, however, as Pakistan launched Operation *Badr* to try once again to cut the link between Kashmir and Ladakh, to isolate Indian Army troops on the Siachen Glacier, and force India to negotiate a settlement of the Kashmir dispute.

